

2. First-time Use: This is where users form their first impression. It's the most critical stage of the lifecycle, as the first impression dictates whether your product or service warrants their time and attention. This is the stage where your design must convert your first-time users into long-time users. Of course, they make the decision, but your UX design will influence them subliminally!

3. Continued Use: This is the stage for most “converted” users. By this stage, they've already decided that your product/service is useful enough for them to use regularly. Here psychological techniques like conditioning play an important role.

4. Passionate Use: Users in this stage can almost be called fanboys. This stage is characterised by high efficiency and increases in productivity. The users are passionate about your product (and hence your UX design) and spontaneously share that passion with others, as they believe it truly helps them. Though it sounds like an ideal stage, it's rarely ever reached.

5. Death: This can happen at any stage of the lifecycle, when users stop using your product/service. It can happen for a variety of reasons: they found a better or free version, the learning curve was too steep or the interface was too cumbersome, among other things. Either way, doing a post-mortem following this stage is a good way to gain insight into shortcomings and necessary enhancements.

The behaviours of the personas must be considered in every stage of the usage lifecycle and their needs and goals should adapt accordingly. This process is commonly called “storyboarding”. It's very important to consider the lifecycle, because the same persona in a different stage has different capabilities, needs and problems, and hence a different experience with the same design. Therefore, they pose a different design challenge in every stage, and each provides a unique context on its own. In essence, they're a different person at each stage!

Data

This data isn't a repetition, or the results of User Research. It's collected post launch. Post launch of the prototype, at least. We've already seen how the UX design process is a repetitive cycle – collecting data is towards one end of that cycle.